Extended essay: commentary for example essay			
DP subject: (Subject-focused essay)	**ENGLISH B**		
DP subjects: (Interdisciplinary essay)		Interdisciplinary framework:	
Research question:	**To what extent does Emily Bronte's portrayal of female characters in her novel Wuthering Heights indicate that she was a proto-feminist?**		
Assessment details			
Criterion:	Mark awarded:	Commentary: (Incorporating wording from the assessment criteria)	
A: Framework for the essay [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	The research question is relevant to the topic, clearly expressed and focused. The research methods are effective: the novel is the primary source and is referenced regularly to illustrate characters and their behaviour; a good variety of appropriate secondary resources is used to support claims about the gender roles in 19th C. Structural conventions – introduction, argument in three separate points, and conclusion – are clear.	
B: Knowledge and understanding [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	Research materials are relevant and their use shows understanding of the subject matter. Both the novel and secondary resources are used effectively to establish knowledge of the issues concerning women at the time. Relevant terminology is used accurately, to show understanding. Some relevant concepts are explained, though "proto-feminism" should have been defined in the introduction.	
C: Analysis and line of argument [Maximum possible mark: 6]	**5**	Analysis is generally effective and findings are relevant. There is a clear line of argument tracing the different positions of the three women, and linking the RQ, the findings and the conclusion.	
D: Discussion and evaluation [Maximum possible mark: 8]	**5**	There is a balanced discussion of the significance of the findings, which is supported by evidence. The effectiveness of the essay, however, is not evaluated clearly; strengths and limitations are not discussed.	
E: Reflection [Maximum possible mark: 4]	**3**	Reflection on the learning experience is partially evaluative and includes some examples of development of research and essay-writing skills.	

		Reflection shows some evidence of the student's growth in learning.
Total marks awarded	**23 /30**	
Holistic comment on the essay:	The essay is a good reflection of the "feminist" issues found in the novel, supported by research into the social and gender situations of the time. Though the discussion of both the characters and the social issues is somewhat simplified and there is a lack of deeper insight into Bronte's purpose, the structure of the argument is clear and there is good understanding of the main points. Secondary research is used effectively. The conclusion sums up the writer's argument, and relates the situation of the 19th C to that of today.	